

HP Deskjet 460cb Mobile**Small In Size, Big On Quality**

A compact photo printer that gets the job done in style; in fact, it's a safe bet to say this one should give many normal-sized inkjets a run for their money. An excellent buy for the professional who needs to cart his printer around.

**Looks And Features**

The 460cb is by far the smallest printer we've received. The in and out paper trays and the top flap have been designed to fit flush with each other. The build quality of the movable parts is excellent. Being a photo printer, the 460cb comes with an SD/MMC and a CF slot. It uses the standard black/tri-colour cartridges—no individual tanks here.

[HP Deskjet 460cb Mobile](#)

- An ultra-compact printer; very portable
 - Excellent for photographs
 - Very good build quality
 - Costly and not really worth the price unless portability is of tantamount importance
- Price: Rs 14,999

Performance

Under our text tests, the 460cb performed commendably, with no blotting at high quality. In Draft mode, the document showed signs of blotting, although this wasn't very noticeable. At high-quality settings, the printout was as close to perfect as we've seen. This is thus a very good printer for monochrome printing, and is

fast as well, taking 11 and 14 seconds in our draft and high-quality tests respectively.

Our combi-test was handled very well too, with the text crisp and clear. The embedded photo was reproduced well, with minor artefacts at normal settings. At both quality settings, the fruit basket was perfectly reproduced with excellent detail on the colours, and realistic textures.

With such results, we were optimistic about the photo test as well. The diminutive 460cb galloped along, taking only three minutes and 53 seconds to print an A4 size photo. Photo quality was impressive: the flowers in the foreground looked good, with good detail around the petals. Facial features looked life-like, with perfect colour blending, giving a realistic texture feel to the skin. Tones were vivid, yet not overly bright. This printer can handle contrasts very well, and the bright-coloured bracelet was reproduced perfectly. Even the red silk coverlet looked rich and vivid—something a few of the printers missed out on.

This printer delivers performance, and is, like we said, very compact. No compromises whatsoever! The only sore point is the price—Rs 14,999. Still, for the professional who might need to cart around a printer with him, the HP 460cb will deliver with aplomb!

HP Photosmart 7838**Doesn't Really Live Up To Its Name**

The 7838 is a feature-rich printer with all the goodies such as PictBridge and support for multiple memory slots. Its looks will win the hearts of many, while the inclusion of a discrete photo cartridge along with the package make it a sweet value-for-money deal.

Looks And Features

The HP PhotoSmart 7838 is a photo printer with top-class build quality. The fit and finish of the paper trays and top panel are great.

The 7838 comes with PictBridge support. It also supports SD/ MMC/CF and XD memory cards. This printer has a two-cartridge setup: the black one can be swapped for a photo cartridge.

Performance

The 7838 produced clear, crisp text without visible quality loss. At draft settings, we noticed some artefacting—unacceptable for a printer in this price range. At the higher settings, there was no loss in quality.

The printer fared rather badly in our combi-document test—surprising for such a printer. The embedded photo was distorted, and the contrast test saw a hardly-legible output when the font size was reduced. The detail in the fruit scene was also missing, and the colours also could have been

better. Quality and clarity was somewhat better at high settings, but this is expected, though we feel the entire page could have been a tad better. Speed wasn't an issue: the printer took one minute and four seconds at the high-quality setting.

The 7838 completed the photo in three minutes and three seconds. We did two photo printouts—one with the regular black cartridge, and another with the photo cartridge. With the photo cartridge, the printout took 24 seconds longer. With the regular cartridge the photo looked a bit dull, and there was easily-detectable graininess. With the photo cartridge, the graininess disappeared, as did the problem with vividness. The tones looked much richer—in fact, we felt the yellow sofa was over-saturated, but the lack of a dedicated black cartridge (you need to pull out the black cartridge when inserting the photo cartridge) caused quite a few problems, particularly noticeable as blurring in the hair and around the pupils of the eye of the subject.

All in all a very well-built, feature-rich printer, but the performance is mediocre for Rs 5,499. There are cheaper options that do the job better.



[HP Photosmart 7838](#)

- Very good looks; a good colour combination has been used
 - Supports PictBridge plus a lot of different memory slots
 - Well-priced for the features it brings to the table
 - Mixed results in the text and combi tests, where the printer performed well only at higher settings, which will consume more ink
 - Not really great for photo printing, which is the segment it's aimed at!
- Price: Rs 5,499